

Armed Guard Upgrade Path

What an existing unarmed guard needs to carry on duty in New York City — and where this differs from the standard carry licence we already handle.

Applies to NYC • NYPD License Division Verified 21 Aug 2026 Realistic timeline 12–18 months First case sponsored by ISS Action, Inc.

THE SEQUENCE

Order is not a convenience here — it is a legal dependency chain. Each step is gated on the one above it, and the expensive mistake is paying for training before the licence that permits it.

1

Security guard registration HE HAS THIS

NYS DEPARTMENT OF STATE

The 8-hour pre-assignment course and the 16-hour on-the-job training, then registration with the Division of Licensing Services. This is the base credential, and it stays the base credential — armed status is an upgrade to it, not a replacement.

Confirm before anything else: that his registration is current, and that he is up to date on the 8-hour annual in-service. A lapsed registration blocks step 3 outright.

2

NYPD Carry Guard licence THE LONG POLE

NYPD LICENSE DIVISION • 9–18 MONTHS

This is the handgun licence itself, and it is the whole job. It is the same application we already run people through — the same documents, the same references, the same disclosures, the same lifetime driving abstract — plus four additions covered below.

It is employer-tied. The NYPD states that applications for this licence type "must be made with the documentation provided by a company's gun custodian." He cannot pursue this alone — the sponsoring company has to be part of the filing. See *The sponsor* below.

3

Pre-licence exemption, then the 47-hour course

REQUESTED WITH THE APPLICATION • NYPD, THEN A DCJS-APPROVED SCHOOL

The state says you need a pistol licence to enrol in the 47-hour course. The NYPD's answer to that is **38 RCNY § 5-09, "Application for Pre-License Exemption"** — written specifically for carry guard applicants who need to handle a handgun for instruction before their licence exists.

- Submit the written request **at the time of filing** the handgun application — not after
- Include a signed statement from an authorised instructor certifying the applicant poses no danger, with the instructor's credentials and the exact training location

- The Division Head investigates criminal history within 10 business days, then approves or denies within 10 business days of that
- The exemption dies if the licence application is denied or new disqualifying information appears

Then the course itself: **7 hours** classroom on use of force and Penal Law Article 35 with a written exam, plus **40 hours** of range training ending in a weapons qualification.

4

Armed guard registration

NYS DEPARTMENT OF STATE • FORM DOS-1619

With the certificate issued, he files the **Security Guard Change of Status (DOS-1619)** to move his existing registration to armed classification, with the 47-hour certificate attached. The fee was listed at \$25 — confirm it immediately before mailing, since DOS forms and fees change.

5

Annual maintenance — permanently

EVERY CALENDAR YEAR HE HOLDS ARMED STATUS

- **8-hour annual in-service** — the guard requirement he already has
- **8-hour annual firearms in-service** — 3 hours use-of-force classroom with a written exam, 5 hours qualification with a proficiency exam

Registrations run two years, so a full cycle is two of each. Miss a year and renewal fails. This is a recurring revenue line, not a one-off.

WHICH NYPD CATEGORY TO FILE

This is decided by where he lives, not where he works, and getting it wrong wastes a filing fee.

APPLICANT'S SITUATION	CATEGORY	CHECK BEFORE FILING
Lives in one of the five boroughs	Carry Guard	Confirm ISS sponsorship packet is in hand
Lives in NY State outside NYC and already holds a county pistol licence	Special Carry Guard	County licence active; upload front and back

If his residence or existing-licence situation is unusual in any way, confirm the category with the License Division before payment or submission. The Carry Guard unit can be reached at DG_LIC-Carry-Guard@NYPD.ORG, and the Handgun Section on [\(646\) 610-5560](tel:6466105560) — but confirm current instructions before sending anything sensitive by email.

WHERE OUR CONCIERGE SERVICE STOPS

This licence type puts us closer to the applicant's portal account than the standard carry track does, because the employer packet flows through us. The boundary has to be explicit, and it is the same principle that governs the disclosures on our main product: **we prepare, they attest.**

WE CAN DO THIS	ONLY THEY CAN DO THIS
Provide the checklist and timeline	Hold their own email, password and MFA
Populate drafts from facts they supply	Supply every factual answer and disclosure
Review for missing or inconsistent documents	Sign and swear every attestation
Coordinate the ISS company packet	Personally review the completed application
Organise, label and check the upload files	Click the final submit control
Guide them through the portal screens	Attend fingerprinting and any interview

Use a screen-share, not their credentials. A guided session where the applicant drives keeps them in possession of the account and in the position of making their own certifications. Written consent to assist is worth having in the business file, but it does not override portal terms, notarisation rules, or the law on false statements and unauthorised access.

ISS's own signatures, notarisations and employer certifications are theirs to execute too. We coordinate that packet; we never complete it for them.

WHAT'S ADDITIONAL TO A STANDARD CARRY LICENCE

The base application is identical to the one our platform already assembles. Only four items are genuinely new, and one of them is a relationship rather than a document.

REQUIREMENT	STANDARD CONCEALED CARRY	CARRY GUARD
Photo ID, date of birth, citizenship, proof of residence	Required	Required
Lifetime driving abstract, per state	Required	Required
Cohabitant affidavits, safeguard form, disclosures	Required	Required
Notarised character references	Four (two base + two extra)	Two — base only
16-hour DCJS course + 2-hour live fire	Required	Not on the Carry Guard list
Three years of social media accounts	Required	Not on the Carry Guard list
47-hour state-approved firearms course	—	Additional
Letter of necessity from his employer	—	Additional
20-hour worksheet	—	Additional
Child support certification form	—	Additional
Application filed via the employer's gun custodian	—	Structural

The gun custodian is the real gate. Everything on that list except the custodian relationship is paperwork we already know how to produce. The custodian is a person at the sponsoring company who holds their own NYPD credential, and through whom guard applications are made.

That makes the custodian our counterparty as much as the applicant is. Get their name and direct contact at the start — the letter of necessity and the custodian documentation both come from them, and chasing an unnamed person at a large firm is how a file sits idle for a month.

What we need from ISS, itemised

- The **NYPD Carry Guard company form**, completed and notarised where required
- The **letter of necessity** in the current NYPD format — armed duties, business need, anticipated start, work locations or assignment type, and at least 20 hours per week where required
- The completed **20-hour worksheet**, consistent with what the letter says
- Full name, contact details and **NYPD licence number of the designated gun custodian**
- ISS's exact legal entity name and active **New York Watch, Guard or Patrol Agency licence** — number, expiry, and a copy they supply
- Written confirmation of the sponsored armed position, job title and assignment site
- Firearm details if requested — company-issued or employee-owned, make, model, calibre, serial number, and the approved storage arrangement

Take every one of these from a verified ISS representative. Do not pull licence numbers or custodian details from a public directory — a wrong number on a notarised company form is a rejected filing.

THE SPONSOR

ISS Action, Inc. — headquartered at 158-12 Rockaway Boulevard, Suite 200, Jamaica, Queens. Licensed by the NYS Department of State, Division of Licensing Services, and licensed or pending in roughly fifteen other states. Federally certified, women-owned, with contracts including DHS, the U.S. Marshals Service, the U.S. Army and NASA. Their own service list states plainly: *"Both armed and unarmed, our security officers are highly trained and committed to keeping you safe."*

Queens is inside the five boroughs, so NYPD License Division jurisdiction is correct and the Carry Guard route is the right one. The sponsor question from the first draft of this guide is answered: he has a real, established, appropriately licensed employer.

THE ONE THING STILL TO CONFIRM

Armed work does not by itself mean an NYPD gun custodian

A firm can run armed posts without holding the NYC credential this application depends on. Armed officers on federal contracts operate under federal authority on federal property, and their New York State centralised contract for guard services is explicitly *"limited to unarmed guards."* Neither tells us what we need to know.

The question for ISS Action is narrow and specific: **do you hold an NYPD Carry Business licence, and who is your designated gun custodian?** If yes, this proceeds. If their NYC armed work runs entirely through federal posts, there may be no custodian to file through, and the answer to the client is different.

Ask that before taking payment. It is one email to the person who referred him.

Treat this as a channel, not a client. ISS Action is a multi-state firm with federal contracts, and they came to us asking for help with the application process — not with one guard's paperwork. If the custodian relationship checks out, the same packet repeats for every guard they upgrade, and the annual firearms in-service recurs for each one indefinitely.

Worth asking on the same call: how many guards are you looking to move to armed status this year?

WHAT THIS LICENCE DOES NOT GIVE HIM

NYPD, ON THE CARRY GUARD RESTRICTION

"The handgun may be carried only while the licensee is actively engaged in employment for the company whose name appears on the license and/or while licensee is in transit directly to or from residence and place of employment."

Set this expectation on the first call. A Carry Guard licence is a work credential, not personal carry — it is tied to the named employer, and it ends when that employment does. Applicants who assume they are buying a concealed carry licence and discover the restriction at issuance are the ones who feel misled.

If he wants personal carry as well, that is a separate concealed carry application on its own timeline. Worth raising early, because it changes what he should buy from us.

One more question for him directly: **where does he live?** The licence is tied to ISS Action's NYC employment, but an applicant residing outside the five boroughs adds a county-licence wrinkle worth identifying now rather than at submission.

Sources. NY DCJS — mandated security guard training courses · NYS Department of State — security guard training requirements · NYPD License Division — required documents · NYPD — licence types and application instructions · 38 RCNY § 5-09 — pre-licence exemption · NYPD — sponsoring company forms · DOS-1619 — change of status · ISS Action — services · ISS Action — licences · NYS OGS — ISS Action guard services contract

Regulatory summary compiled 21 August 2026, not legal advice. Requirements and fees change; confirm against the agencies before advising a client or taking payment.